

The Boundary Sheet

Word-for-word scripts for protecting your energy at work — by profile

Find Your Best Job — A 7-Profile Career Assessment

How to Use This Sheet

This document gives you actual language — not principles, not advice, but specific words — for the boundary situations your profile is most likely to face. A boundary is a specific, stated decision about what you will and will not do, held consistently regardless of how you feel in the moment. It is not a feeling. It is a visible limit you communicate and maintain.

Four Principles

1	You do not owe an explanation. A limit stated clearly is a complete sentence. The more you explain, the more room you leave for negotiation.
2	The limit must come from a decision, not a mood. Consistency is what makes it a boundary rather than unpredictability.
3	Practise the scripts out loud before you need them. The awkwardness fades with repetition. The habit builds with use.
4	Go to your profile section. Find two or three phrases that fit how you actually talk. Make them yours.

The Challenge for This Profile

Saying no feels like abandonment. When someone is in distress, setting a limit feels like failing them. You absorb more than is healthy and often do not notice until you are already depleted.

Scripts to Use

When someone brings you more than you can carry

"I genuinely care about what you're going through — and I'm not in a place to hold this well right now. Can we talk later this week when I can give it the attention it deserves?"

When someone relies on you as their primary support

"I'm here for you, and I also think you need more support than I'm able to be. Let's find someone who can help you properly."

When a colleague keeps bringing emotional weight to your desk

"I hear you. I need to stay focused for the next hour — can we catch up at [specific time]?"

General no script

"That's not something I'm able to take on right now. — Full stop. No further explanation needed."

Remember

You can hold someone's pain with genuine care and still say no. Those two things are not in conflict.

The Challenge for This Profile

You find it almost impossible to say no to a need. You keep adding tasks without removing any and rarely raise a flag until you are already overextended.

Scripts to Use

When asked to take on one more thing

"I want to help — I'm currently at capacity. If this takes priority over something else, let's agree on what to move. Otherwise I can pick this up on [date]."

When someone assumes you will do something you were not asked to do

"I noticed that landed on my list without us agreeing it should. Can we clarify whether this is mine to own?"

When you are carrying more than your role requires

"I've been carrying [X] for a while now, which was not originally my responsibility. I'd like to talk about whether that should change formally."

When being taken for granted

"I'm glad to help. I do want to flag that I've been absorbing quite a bit recently — I'd appreciate some acknowledgment of that."

Remember

Not every need is yours to meet. Saying no to one thing is often what makes it possible to do the right thing well.

The Challenge for This Profile

Your boundary challenge is less about volume and more about being pushed to act before you are ready. You are also at risk of letting frustration with imprecision damage relationships you need.

Scripts to Use

When asked to decide before you have enough information

"I want to give you a considered answer. I need [X time / X information] before I can do that responsibly. Can we set a deadline for when I get back to you?"

When someone keeps interrupting focused work

"I'm in deep work right now. I'll be available at [time] — can this wait until then?"

When impatience is rising toward someone not keeping up

"Let me come at this from a different angle. — Not: 'let me explain it again.'"

When asked to sign off on work you believe is inaccurate

"I'm not comfortable putting my name to this in its current state. Here is what needs to be corrected first."

Remember

You do not have to soften your standards. You do have to deliver them in a way that keeps the conversation open.

The Challenge for This Profile

Your boundary challenge is often about scope — you take on more than you should because you see what needs doing. The cost is usually paid by the people around you, not by you.

Scripts to Use

Before overriding someone else's work

"Pause. Ask: What would it cost to let this be done their way? If the answer is very little — let it be."

When a goal keeps expanding beyond what was agreed

"We need to recalibrate. Here is what was originally scoped, here is what has been added, and here is what needs to come off the list."

When someone challenges your direction

"Tell me what you're seeing. I want to understand the concern before I respond. — Then actually listen."

When asked to decide outside your authority

"That decision belongs with [person]. I can support it, but I should not be the one making it."

Remember

The outcome matters. So do the people who help you get there. Developing others IS the outcome — not a cost of it.

The Challenge for This Profile

You give willingly and often without conditions — which makes you a target for people who know how to appear in need without genuinely being so. Your challenge is discernment, not generosity.

Scripts to Use

When a request for help feels off

"I want to help in a way that's actually useful. Tell me more about what you've tried already. — Genuine need can answer this. Strategic positioning usually cannot."

When someone keeps returning for support without showing change

"I've been glad to help. I'm not going to keep contributing to the same situation unless something is going to be different this time. What's changing?"

When asked to invest without enough information

"I make resource decisions carefully. I need to understand [X] before I can commit."

When your generosity is assumed rather than asked for

"I give when I choose to give. Let me think about whether this is something I want to be part of."

Remember

Generosity without discernment is not virtue — it is exposure. Saying no to the wrong request protects your ability to say yes to the right one.

The Challenge for This Profile

Your boundary challenge is not saying too little — it is saying too much in the wrong way, at the wrong moment. Directness that closes a conversation has not accomplished anything.

Scripts to Use

Before delivering a hard truth

"Ask: Is this the right moment? Is this person in a state to hear it? Am I delivering this from genuine concern or from frustration?"

When giving feedback that might land as harsh

"I want to give you honest feedback because I think it will actually help. Is this a good moment to hear it?"

When you feel the urge to correct someone publicly

"Choose the private conversation when possible: Can I share something with you one-on-one?"

When your directness has damaged a relationship

"I said that because I was concerned — not to hurt you. I could have chosen a better moment. I'm sorry for how it landed."

Remember

The goal is truth that lands — not truth delivered. If it did not land, it did not fully achieve what you intended.

The Challenge for This Profile

Your boundary challenge is knowing when to stop supporting someone who is not doing their own work. Continued encouragement of someone who is not changing can keep them comfortable in a place they need to leave.

Scripts to Use

When you have encouraged the same person toward the same change repeatedly

"I've believed in you through this for a while. I'm going to be honest: I don't think anything changes until [specific thing] changes. What's getting in the way of that?"

When someone uses your encouragement as a substitute for action

"I'm not going to keep telling you that you can do this if you're not going to try. I care about you too much to stay comfortable in this conversation."

When you are giving more to a relationship than you are receiving

"I've been showing up consistently here. I need to know this is a two-way investment."

When asked to encourage something you have genuine concerns about

"I want to support you — and I want to be honest with you, because that's part of what support means. Can I share a concern first?"

Remember

Real encouragement sometimes looks like holding someone to what they said they wanted. It is not always warm. It is always honest.